

ANNEX B: 11 KEY PRIORITY AREAS

THEMATIC AREAS	DESCRIPTION¹
1. Job Creation	<i>The DOST commits to advancing globally competitive research and development (R&D) and pursuing technology translation and innovation to produce value-added products, services, and solutions. The DOST will continue scaling up the adoption and utilization of R&D outputs and S& T Services that enable more efficient, demand driven, smart, sustainable, fully integrated, and agile processes thereby creating more employment opportunities in the manufacturing and service sectors.</i>
2. Food Security	<i>The DOST will boost food security through S& T-based food systems innovations. It will invest in programs to develop technologies that foster sustainable production and consumption in agriculture, aquatic and natural resources (AANR) sector. This includes development and/or application of new technologies to improve production efficiency in agriculture, livestock, fisheries, and forestry to ensure food security. Further, this will cover S& T programs for more cost-effective postharvest handling, agricultural product processing, and agribusiness, marketing, and value chain development. Critical and emerging agricultural issues and challenges will be addressed while developing and promoting viable food system policy and governance.</i>
3. Health Security	<i>The DOST will take its part in ensuring health security for all by implementing research programs on health aligned with the Harmonized National Research and Development Agenda (HNRDA) and the National Unified Health Research Agenda (NUHRA). In particular, the Department will prioritize research on such areas as functional foods, nutrition, nutrigenomics, food safety, drug discovery and development, emerging and re-emerging infectious diseases, digital and frontier technologies for health, among others.</i>
4. Water Security and Environmental Protection	<i>The DOST will support and implement programs that focus on the preservation, management, and sustainable use of natural resources. This includes initiatives that will allow the natural environment to build resilience and recover from adverse impacts of natural and man-made disasters and climate change. To increase access to clean water, the Department shall promote mechanisms for holistic planning and management and shall advocate the use of technology to maintain water quality and control pollution.</i>
5. Energy Security	<i>The DOST will continue to support the development of alternative energy-related technologies through localization, standards development, and innovations. The Department shall likewise push for a transition to clean and green energy sources to achieve energy security in the country.</i>
6. Transportation System	<i>To improve mobility, the DOST shall develop solutions for efficient and responsive transport systems. Accordingly, S& T programs/projects will be geared towards the provision of efficient, seamless, safe, and secure physical movement of the flow of goods and people while ensuring equitable mobility opportunities through better urban-rural linkages and reducing carbon footprints from the transport sector.</i>
7. Climate and Disaster Resilience	<i>The DOST will continue to support S& T programs/projects that help build resilience from the impacts of climate change and natural and man-made disasters. Disaster risk reduction and mitigation (DRRM) mechanisms will be mainstreamed in development initiatives such as policy formulation and socio-economic development planning. Likewise, the development and provision of STI-based DRRM strategies will be strengthened. This covers improvements in the existing mitigation technology infrastructure such as radar stations, flood forecasting and warning systems, and volcano and earthquake monitoring systems. DRRM information, education,</i>

¹ Description as of 15 January 2024

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	<i>and communication efforts will also be intensified. The DOST will also strengthen capacities in preventing and mitigating disasters at all levels.</i>
8. STI Human Resource Development	<i>DOST will strengthen its S& T scholarship programs to produce the critical mass of qualified S& T human resources who can help steer the country towards national development. Relatedly, the DOST will raise the bar of quality science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) education that prepares students to become the next generation of scientists, inventors, and researchers as well as develop more initiatives that will cultivate science culture and critical minds among the youth.</i>
9. Facilities Upgrading	<i>Facility upgrading will be undertaken to support and produce a conducive environment for various stakeholders in the national S& T ecosystem. This will be in the form of state-of-the-art testing laboratories, facilities, and equipment geared towards ensuring better organizational productivity and improved delivery of public goods and services. Support for the establishment and/or upgrading of innovation hubs, R&D centers, technology business incubators, start-ups, and Knowledge and Innovation Science and Technology (KIST) Parks will also be in the offing.</i>
10. Digital Transformation	<i>The DOST will adopt digital transformation and other change management strategies that will provide quality services, efficient bureaucratic processes, and timely, data-driven responses. Through the S& T-enabled systems, the Department will improve its monitoring, evaluation and assessment processes and mechanisms towards institutionalizing more evidence-based, participatory, and efficient planning and policy development mechanisms.</i>
11. Smart and Sustainable Cities and Communities	<i>The DOST will respond to calls for inclusive and sustainable urban development interventions that consider the implication of rapid population growth and settlement, urbanization, and rural-urban migration. This will be carried out by maximizing the use of STI while harnessing indigenous knowledge and local talents, building data infrastructure that will be used as basis in management decisions, and identifying opportunities for citizens to pursue prosperity and fulfillment across all regions of the country.</i>